anything, we proudly click Add to Cart and look at her, eager for the praise we know will come. Instead, she looks surprised. “You called me over to show me a bug?” she asks. “You click that button, and nothing happens.”

We patiently explain that, in fact, a lot happened. Just look at the cart in the sidebar. See? When we add something, the quantity changes from 4 to 5.

“Oh,” she says, “I didn’t notice that.” And if she didn’t notice the page update, it’s likely that our users won’t either. It’s time for some user interface hacking.